

L2L Framework: Data Preparation

LAPOP Mexico 2023 & Latinobarómetro Colombia 2023

Kevin Linares (JPSM, University of Maryland)

2026-02-24

```
pacman::p_load(sjlabelled, psych, knitr,  
               viridis, patchwork, lavaan, semTools, tidyverse)  
  
set.seed(721)  
  
results_dir <- "D:/repos/UMD_classes_code/TSE_II_SURV721/results"  
dir.create(results_dir, recursive = TRUE, showWarnings = FALSE)
```

Overview

This script prepares two survey datasets for the Latent-to-Language (L2L) framework:

- **LAPOP Mexico 2023** — AmericasBarometer, 18-item trust/system support battery
- **Latinobarómetro Colombia 2023** — 9-item institutional trust battery

For each survey, we:

- (1) load raw data
- (2) inspect value labels to understand coding
- (3) select and recode variables
- (4) assess missingness and drop high-missing demographics
- (5) apply listwise deletion
- (6) validate the final dataset.

LAPOP Mexico 2023

Load and Inspect

```
lapop_raw <- read_spss(  
  "D:/repos/UMD_classes_code/TSE_II_SURV721/lapop/MEX_2023_LAPOP_AmericasBarometer_v1.0_w.sav") |>  
  tibble()
```

Converting atomic to factors. Please wait...

Trust items “Trust in”

Coded as 1 = Not at all, . . ., 7 = a lot.

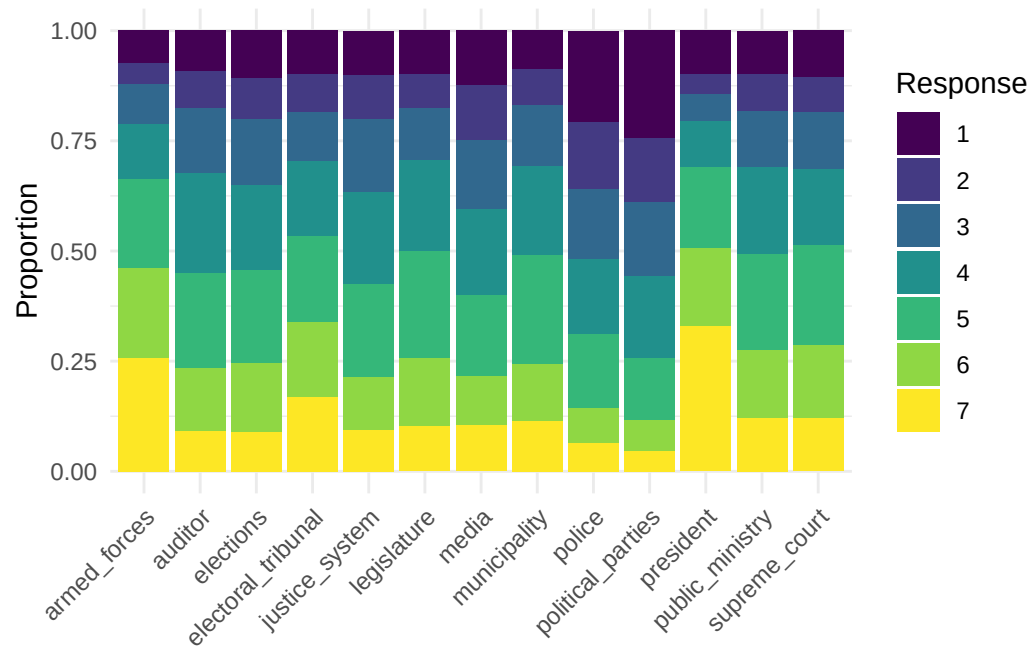
```

trust_items <- c("b10a", "b11", "b12", "b13", "b15",
                "b18", "b19", "b21", "b21a", "b31",
                "b32", "b37", "b47a")

lapop_trust_names <- c(
  justice_system = "b10a",
  electoral_tribunal = "b11",
  armed_forces = "b12",
  legislature = "b13",
  public_ministry = "b15",
  police = "b18",
  auditor = "b19",
  political_parties = "b21",
  president = "b21a",
  supreme_court = "b31",
  municipality = "b32",
  media = "b37",
  elections = "b47a"
)

lapop_raw |>
  select(all_of(trust_items)) |>
  rename(!!!lapop_trust_names) |>
  drop_na() |>
  pivot_longer(everything(), names_to = "item", values_to = "value") |>
  count(item, value) |>
  ggplot(aes(x = item, y = n, fill = factor(value))) +
  geom_col(position = "fill") +
  scale_fill_viridis_d() +
  labs(x = NULL, y = "Proportion", fill = "Response") +
  theme_minimal() +
  theme(axis.text.x = element_text(angle = 45, hjust = 1))

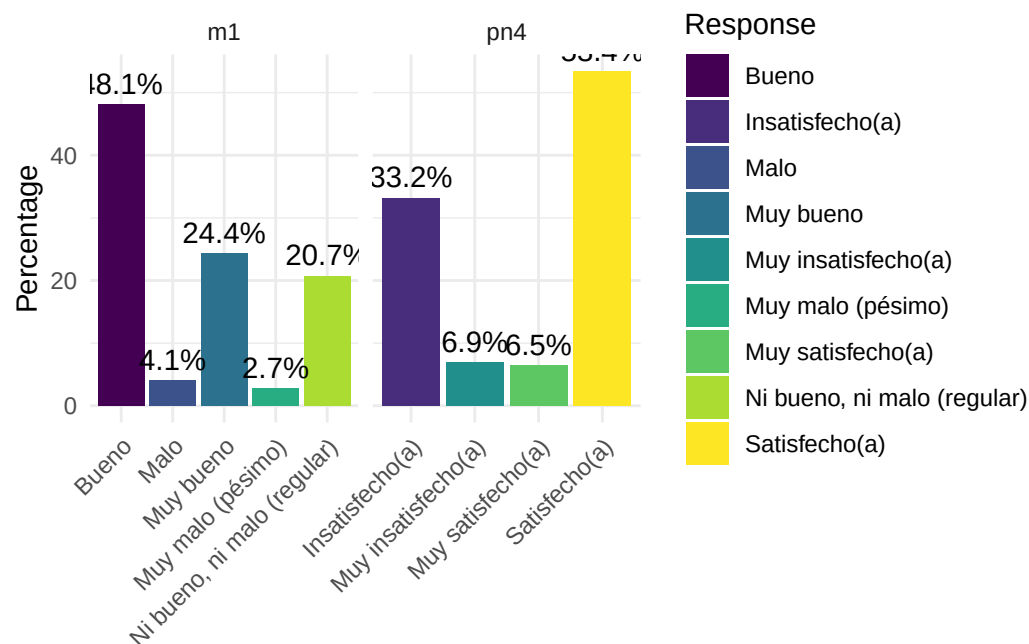
```



Trust items

Outcome Variables

```
lapop_raw |>
  select(pn4, m1) |>
  mutate_all(sjlabelled::as_character) |>
  pivot_longer(everything(),
               names_to = "Outcome", values_to = "Response") |>
  drop_na() |>
  group_by(Outcome, Response) |>
  count() |>
  group_by(Outcome) |>
  mutate(pct = n / sum(n) * 100) |>
  ggplot(aes(x = Response, y = pct, fill = Response)) +
  geom_col() +
  geom_text(aes(label = sprintf("%.1f%%", pct)), vjust = -0.5) +
  facet_wrap(~Outcome, scales = "free_x") +
  labs(y = "Percentage", x = NULL) +
  scale_fill_viridis_d() +
  theme_minimal() +
  theme(axis.text.x = element_text(angle = 45, hjust = 1))
```



M1 is presidential rating. The following are the labels translated from Spanish.

- 1 = Very good
- 2 = Good
- 3 = Neither good nor bad
- 4 = Bad
- 5 = Very Bad

pn4 is satisfaction with democracy

- 1 = Very satisfied
- 2 = satisfied
- 3 = dissatisfied
- 4 = very dissatisfied

Recode data

```
# demographics
lapop_demo_source <- c("q1tc_r", "q2", "edre", "ur", "ocup4a")

lapop <- lapop_raw |>
  select(all_of(c(trust_items, lapop_demo_source, "pn4", "m1"))) |>
  rename(!!!lapop_trust_names) |>
  mutate(across(all_of(setdiff(lapop_demo_source, "q2")), as_character)) |>
  # rename variables & recode values to english
  mutate(
    # bin age
    age_cat = cut(q2,
```

```

        breaks = c(17, 29, 44, 59, Inf),
        labels = c("18-29", "30-44", "45-59", "60+"),
        right = TRUE),

# recode gender to factor with female as reference group
sex = ifelse(q1tc_r == "Mujer/femenino", "Female", "Male"),
male = factor(sex),

# recode education
Edu = case_when(
  edre == "Ninguna" ~ "none",
  edre == "Primaria incompleta" ~ "primary",
  edre == "Primaria completa" ~ "primary",
  edre ==
    "Secundaria o Educación Media Superior/Bachillerato/Preparatoria/Profesional Técnico incompleta" ~ "secondary",
  edre ==
    "Secundaria o Educación Media Superior/Bachillerato/Preparatoria/Profesional Técnico completa" ~ "secondary",
  edre ==
    "Universitaria, superior no universitaria o técnico universitario completa" ~ "higher_ed",
  edre ==
    "Universitaria, superior no universitaria o técnico universitario incompleta" ~ "higher_ed",
  TRUE ~ NA_character_
),
Edu = factor(Edu,
             levels = c("none", "primary", "secondary", "higher_ed")),

# urban factor
Urban = factor(ifelse(ur=="Urbano", "urban", "rural")),

# recode occupation status
Employment = case_when(
  ocup4a == "Trabajando?" ~ "Employed",
  ocup4a == "No está trabajando en este momento pero tiene trabajo?" ~ "Employed",
  ocup4a == "Se dedica a los quehaceres de su hogar?" ~ "house_wife",
  ocup4a == "Es estudiante?" ~ "Student",
  ocup4a ==
    "Está jubilado, pensionado o incapacitado permanentemente para trabajar?" ~ "Retired",
  ocup4a == "Está buscando trabajo activamente?" ~ "Unemployed",
  ocup4a == "No trabaja y no está buscando trabajo?" ~ "Unemployed",
  TRUE ~ NA_character_),
Employment = factor(Employment),

# recode outcomes
satis_demo_lapop = pn4,
prez_rating = m1
) |>
# listwise deletion
drop_na() |>
# drop variables we no longer need
select(!all_of(lapop_demo_source), -sex, -pn4, -m1)

lapop |> glimpse()

```

Rows: 1,430

Columns: 20

```
$ justice_system      <dbl> 7, 5, 5, 1, 2, 4, 1, 3, 1, 4, 2, 2, 3, 6, 1, 1, 6, ~
$ electoral_tribunal  <dbl> 6, 4, 1, 3, 2, 4, 5, 5, 4, 7, 1, 4, 5, 6, 1, 4, 7, ~
$ armed_forces        <dbl> 7, 6, 3, 6, 6, 7, 6, 3, 1, 7, 4, 4, 5, 4, 4, 5, 7, ~
$ legislature         <dbl> 7, 5, 2, 6, 4, 7, 3, 1, 1, 6, 2, 4, 1, 5, 1, 2, 6, ~
$ public_ministry     <dbl> 6, 5, 4, 4, 4, 4, 3, 5, 3, 3, 1, 2, 4, 6, 1, 3, 7, ~
$ police              <dbl> 4, 6, 5, 4, 1, 5, 1, 4, 1, 5, 2, 2, 4, 6, 1, 4, 1, ~
$ auditor             <dbl> 7, 4, 4, 5, 4, 4, 3, 4, 3, 5, 1, 2, 5, 4, 1, 3, 7, ~
$ political_parties   <dbl> 7, 5, 1, 3, 1, 4, 2, 3, 1, 2, 2, 2, 4, 5, 1, 3, 1, ~
$ president           <dbl> 7, 5, 4, 5, 1, 7, 5, 5, 5, 6, 5, 6, 6, 5, 4, 7, 6, ~
$ supreme_court       <dbl> 7, 5, 3, 2, 2, 4, 2, 4, 1, 4, 2, 2, 4, 4, 1, 5, 6, ~
$ municipality        <dbl> 7, 6, 3, 2, 4, 4, 1, 3, 1, 2, 5, 4, 4, 7, 1, 5, 6, ~
$ media               <dbl> 7, 6, 1, 4, 2, 4, 1, 1, 1, 6, 1, 2, 2, 6, 1, 2, 7, ~
$ elections           <dbl> 7, 5, 3, 1, 3, 4, 4, 1, 4, 3, 2, 4, 4, 5, 4, 5, 7, ~
$ age_cat             <fct> 30-44, 30-44, 30-44, 18-29, 60+, 30-44, 45-59, 18-2~
$ male               <fct> Female, Female, Female, Male, Male, Male, Male, Fem~
$ Edu                 <fct> primary, primary, secondary, secondary, primary, pr~
$ Urban              <fct> rural, rural, rural, urban, rural, rural, urban, ru~
$ Employment         <fct> house_wife, house_wife, Employed, Employed, Employe~
$ satis_demo_lapop    <fct> 1, 3, 2, 3, 2, 2, 2, 2, 3, 2, 1, 2, 2, 2, 3, 2, 2, ~
$ prez_rating        <fct> 1, 3, 2, 2, 2, 2, 2, 2, 2, 3, 2, 2, 2, 2, 3, 2, 1, ~
```

```
map(1:ncol(lapop), function(C) {
  col_name <- names(lapop)[C]
  lapop |> select(all_of(C)) |> rename(Var=1) |> count(Var) |> mutate(column = col_name, .before = 1) |>
    kable()
})
```

[[1]]

column	Var	n
justice_system	1	141
justice_system	2	146
justice_system	3	235
justice_system	4	298
justice_system	5	302
justice_system	6	172
justice_system	7	136

[[2]]

column	Var	n
electoral_tribunal	1	139
electoral_tribunal	2	124
electoral_tribunal	3	160
electoral_tribunal	4	242
electoral_tribunal	5	278
electoral_tribunal	6	245
electoral_tribunal	7	242

[[3]]

column	Var	n
:-----	---:	---:
armed_forces	1	105
armed_forces	2	66
armed_forces	3	128
armed_forces	4	178
armed_forces	5	290
armed_forces	6	295
armed_forces	7	368

[[4]]

column	Var	n
:-----	---:	---:
legislature	1	139
legislature	2	108
legislature	3	172
legislature	4	290
legislature	5	350
legislature	6	226
legislature	7	145

[[5]]

column	Var	n
:-----	---:	---:
public_ministry	1	141
public_ministry	2	119
public_ministry	3	181
public_ministry	4	279
public_ministry	5	313
public_ministry	6	222
public_ministry	7	175

[[6]]

column	Var	n
:-----	---:	---:
police	1	297
police	2	215
police	3	227
police	4	242
police	5	244
police	6	111
police	7	94

[[7]]

column	Var	n
:-----	---:	---:
auditor	1	128
auditor	2	123
auditor	3	209
auditor	4	325
auditor	5	308
auditor	6	206
auditor	7	131

[[8]]

column	Var	n
:-----	---:	---:
political_parties	1	345
political_parties	2	211
political_parties	3	240
political_parties	4	268
political_parties	5	202
political_parties	6	98
political_parties	7	66

[[9]]

column	Var	n
:-----	---:	---:
president	1	140
president	2	69
president	3	81
president	4	152
president	5	262
president	6	254
president	7	472

[[10]]

column	Var	n
:-----	---:	---:
supreme_court	1	148
supreme_court	2	114
supreme_court	3	182
supreme_court	4	251
supreme_court	5	324
supreme_court	6	240
supreme_court	7	171

[[11]]

column	Var	n
--------	-----	---

:-----	---:	---:
municipality	1	127
municipality	2	115
municipality	3	196
municipality	4	292
municipality	5	355
municipality	6	183
municipality	7	162

[[12]]

column	Var	n
:-----	---:	---:
media	1	177
media	2	177
media	3	224
media	4	278
media	5	265
media	6	159
media	7	150

[[13]]

column	Var	n
:-----	---:	---:
elections	1	154
elections	2	131
elections	3	214
elections	4	277
elections	5	302
elections	6	224
elections	7	128

[[14]]

column	Var	n
:-----	---:	---:
age_cat 18-29	468	
age_cat 30-44	361	
age_cat 45-59	369	
age_cat 60+	232	

[[15]]

column	Var	n
:-----	---:	---:
male Female	730	
male Male	700	

[[16]]

column	Var	n
:-----	:-----	---:
Edu	none	25
Edu	primary	273
Edu	secondary	842
Edu	higher_ed	290

[[17]]

column	Var	n
:-----	:-----	---:
Urban	rural	277
Urban	urban	1153

[[18]]

column	Var	n
:-----	:-----	---:
Employment	Employed	766
Employment	house_wife	377
Employment	Retired	87
Employment	Student	88
Employment	Unemployed	112

[[19]]

column	Var	n
:-----	:-----	---:
satis_demo_lapop	1	88
satis_demo_lapop	2	765
satis_demo_lapop	3	475
satis_demo_lapop	4	102

[[20]]

column	Var	n
:-----	:-----	---:
prez_rating	1	342
prez_rating	2	692
prez_rating	3	295
prez_rating	4	63
prez_rating	5	38

We are left with $n=1,430$

Latinobarometro Colombia 2023

Load data

```
lb_raw <- read_rds(
  "D:/repos/UMD_classes_code/TSE_II_SURV721/latinobarrometer/Latinobarometro_2023_Esp_Rds_v1_0.rds") |>
  tibble() |>
  # keep only Colombia
  filter(idenpa == 170)
```

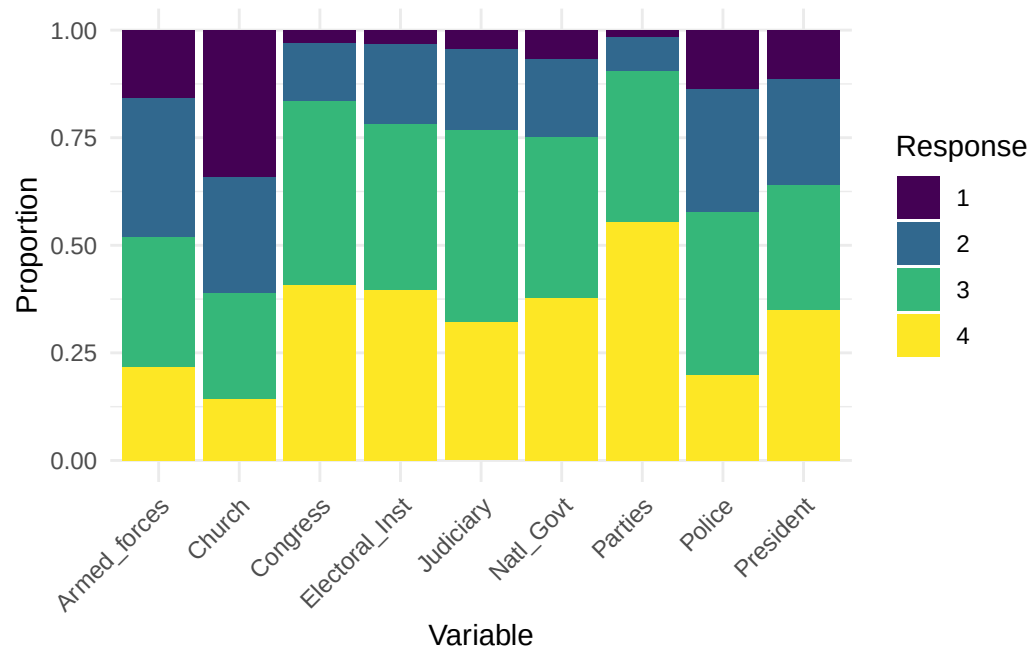
Trust Battery (9 items) and responses translated to English.

- -5 through -1 = NA
- 1 = A lot of trust
- 2 = some trust
- 3 = little trust
- 4 = no trust

```
trust_vars_raw <- c("P13STGBS_A", "P13STGBS_B", "P13ST_C",
  "P13ST_D", "P13ST_E", "P13ST_F",
  "P13ST_G", "P13ST_H", "P13ST_I")

lb_trust_names <- c(Armed_forces = "P13STGBS_A",
  Police = "P13STGBS_B",
  Church = "P13ST_C",
  Congress = "P13ST_D",
  Natl_Govt = "P13ST_E",
  Judiciary = "P13ST_F",
  Parties = "P13ST_G",
  Electoral_Inst = "P13ST_H",
  President = "P13ST_I")

lb_raw |>
  select(all_of(trust_vars_raw)) |>
  rename(!!!lb_trust_names) |>
  mutate(across(everything(), ~ifelse(. %in% -5:-1, NA, .))) |>
  pivot_longer(everything(), names_to = "variable", values_to = "value") |>
  drop_na(value) |>
  count(variable, value) |>
  group_by(variable) |>
  mutate(prop = n / sum(n)) |>
  ggplot(aes(x = variable, y = prop, fill = factor(value))) +
  geom_col() +
  scale_fill_viridis_d() +
  labs(x = "Variable", y = "Proportion", fill = "Response") +
  theme_minimal() +
  theme(axis.text.x = element_text(angle = 45, hjust = 1))
```



Outcome Variables

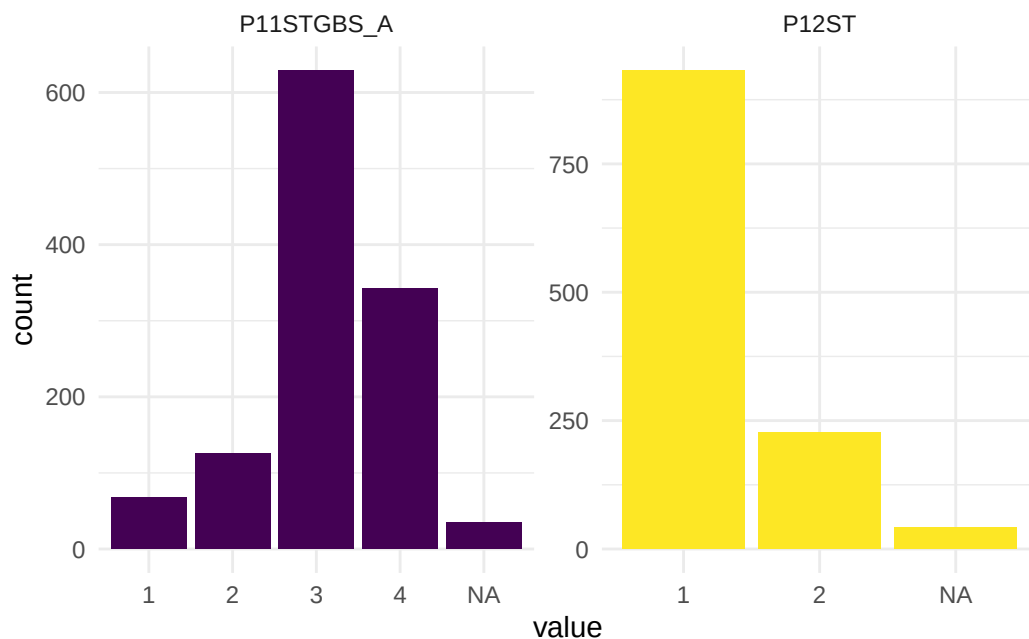
P11STGBS_A Satisfaction with Democracy codings translated into English.

- -5 through -1 = NA
- 1 = Very Satisfied
- 2 = Quite Satisfied
- 3 = Not very satisfied
- 4 = not at all satisfied

P12ST country governed by a few powerful groups, or governed for the good at all codings translated into English

- -5 through -1 = NA
- 1 = powerful groups in their interest
- 2= for the good of all

```
lb_raw |>
  select(P11STGBS_A, P12ST) |>
  mutate(across(everything(), ~if_else(. < 0, NA_real_, .))) |>
  mutate(across(everything(), factor)) |>
  pivot_longer(everything(), names_to = "variable", values_to = "value") |>
  ggplot(aes(x = value)) +
  geom_bar(aes(fill = variable), show.legend = FALSE) +
  facet_wrap(~variable, scales = "free") +
  scale_fill_viridis_d() +
  theme_minimal()
```



Recode data

```
# demographics
lb_demo_source <- c("sexo", "edad",
                    "REEEDUC_1", "tamciud", "S18_A")

lb <- lb_raw |>
  select(all_of(trust_vars_raw), all_of(lb_demo_source), P11STGBS_A, P12ST) |>
  rename(!!!lb_trust_names) |>
  mutate(across(all_of(setdiff(lb_demo_source, "edad")), as_character)) |>

# remove missing data
mutate(across(everything(), ~ifelse(. %in% -5:-1, NA, .)),

       # recode demographics
       male = factor(
         ifelse(sexo == "Hombre", "Male", "Female")),

       # bin age
       age_cat = cut(edad,
                     breaks = c(17, 29, 44, 59, Inf),
                     labels = c("18-29", "30-44", "45-59", "60+"),
                     right = TRUE),

       # recode education
       Edu = case_when(
         REEEDUC_1 == "Analfabeto" ~ "none",
         REEEDUC_1 == "Basica incompleta" ~ "primary",
```

```

REEEDUC_1 == "Basica completa" ~ "primary",
REEEDUC_1 == "Secundaria, media, tecnica completa" ~ "secondary",
REEEDUC_1 == "Secundaria, media, tecnica incompleta" ~ "secondary",
REEEDUC_1 == "Superior completa" ~ "higher_ed",
REEEDUC_1 == "Superior Incompleta" ~ "higher_ed",
TRUE ~ NA_character_
),
Edu = factor(Edu,
              levels = c("none", "primary", "secondary", "higher_ed")),

# urban factor
Urban = case_when(
  tamciud == "(Capital)" ~ "urban",
  tamciud == "100.001 y mas" ~ "urban",
  tamciud == "50.001 - 100.000" ~ "urban",
  tamciud == "40.001 - 50.000" ~ "urban",
  tamciud == "20.001 - 40.000" ~ "rural",
  tamciud == "10.001 - 20.000" ~ "rural",
  tamciud == "5.001 - 10.000" ~ "rural",
  tamciud == "Menos de 5.000" ~ "rural",
  TRUE ~ NA_character_
),

Urban = factor(Urban, levels = c("rural", "urban")),

# recode occupation status
Employment = case_when(
  S18_A == "Independiente/cuenta propia" ~ "Employed",
  S18_A == "Asalariado en emp. privada" ~ "Employed",
  S18_A == "Asalariado en emp. publica" ~ "Employed",
  S18_A ==
    "No trabaja/ responsable de las compras y el cuidado de la casa" ~
    "house_wife",
  S18_A == "Estudiante" ~ "Student",
  S18_A == "Retirado/pensionado" ~ "Retired",
  S18_A == "Temporalmente no trabaja" ~ "Unemployed",
  TRUE ~ NA_character_),
Employment = factor(Employment),

# recode outcomes
satis_demo_lb = P11STGBS_A,
governed_for = P12ST
) |>

# listwise deletion
drop_na() |>

# drop variables we no longer need
select(!all_of(lb_demo_source), -P11STGBS_A, -P12ST)

lb |> glimpse()

```

Rows: 1,073
Columns: 16

```

$ Armed_forces <dbl> 4, 4, 1, 2, 3, 1, 3, 2, 3, 3, 1, 3, 2, 2, 3, 2, 2, 4, 2~
$ Police <dbl> 4, 4, 1, 3, 2, 1, 3, 3, 3, 3, 1, 3, 1, 2, 3, 3, 2, 3, 3~
$ Church <dbl> 3, 4, 2, 4, 2, 1, 3, 3, 1, 4, 3, 3, 1, 1, 3, 1, 3, 3, 3~
$ Congress <dbl> 4, 3, 3, 4, 3, 1, 4, 3, 4, 4, 4, 3, 1, 4, 4, 3, 3, 3, 1~
$ Natl_Govt <dbl> 4, 3, 4, 4, 2, 1, 4, 4, 1, 4, 4, 4, 1, 3, 2, 3, 3, 3, 2~
$ Judiciary <dbl> 4, 4, 3, 4, 2, 1, 4, 4, 4, 4, 2, 3, 1, 2, 4, 3, 3, 3, 2~
$ Parties <dbl> 4, 4, 3, 4, 3, 1, 4, 4, 4, 3, 4, 3, 3, 3, 4, 3, 3, 4, 3~
$ Electoral_Inst <dbl> 4, 4, 3, 4, 3, 1, 3, 3, 4, 4, 4, 3, 1, 2, 3, 4, 3, 4, 2~
$ President <dbl> 4, 4, 3, 4, 2, 1, 2, 4, 3, 4, 4, 4, 1, 3, 3, 3, 2, 4, 2~
$ male <fct> Female, Male, Female, Male, Female, Male, Male, Female,~
$ age_cat <fct> 18-29, 30-44, 18-29, 45-59, 45-59, 18-29, 60+, 18-29, 3~
$ Edu <fct> secondary, higher_ed, secondary, higher_ed, higher_ed, ~
$ Urban <fct> urban, urban, urban, urban, urban, urban, urban, urban,~
$ Employment <fct> house_wife, Employed, Student, Employed, house_wife, Em~
$ satis_demo_lb <dbl> 3, 4, 4, 4, 3, 3, 3, 3, 2, 4, 4, 4, 2, 1, 3, 4, 3, 3, 3~
$ governed_for <dbl> 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 2, 1, 1, 2, 1, 1, 1, 2, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 2~

```

```

map(1:ncol(lb), function(C) {
  col_name <- names(lb)[C]
  lb |> select(all_of(C)) |> rename(Var=1) |> count(Var) |> mutate(column = col_name, .before = 1) |>
    kable()
})

```

```
[[1]]
```

column	Var	n
Armed_forces	1	165
Armed_forces	2	359
Armed_forces	3	320
Armed_forces	4	229

```
[[2]]
```

column	Var	n
Police	1	142
Police	2	317
Police	3	401
Police	4	213

```
[[3]]
```

column	Var	n
Church	1	343
Church	2	294
Church	3	276
Church	4	160

```
[[4]]
```


column	Var	n
:-----	---:	---:
Congress	1	31
Congress	2	140
Congress	3	460
Congress	4	442

[[5]]

column	Var	n
:-----	---:	---:
Natl_Govt	1	72
Natl_Govt	2	198
Natl_Govt	3	402
Natl_Govt	4	401

[[6]]

column	Var	n
:-----	---:	---:
Judiciary	1	47
Judiciary	2	208
Judiciary	3	473
Judiciary	4	345

[[7]]

column	Var	n
:-----	---:	---:
Parties	1	16
Parties	2	79
Parties	3	382
Parties	4	596

[[8]]

column	Var	n
:-----	---:	---:
Electoral_Inst	1	30
Electoral_Inst	2	203
Electoral_Inst	3	426
Electoral_Inst	4	414

[[9]]

column	Var	n
:-----	---:	---:
President	1	122

President		2	267
President		3	308
President		4	376

[[10]]

column	Var		n
:-----	:-----		---:
male	Female		556
male	Male		517

[[11]]

column	Var		n
:-----	:-----		---:
age_cat	18-29		339
age_cat	30-44		356
age_cat	45-59		248
age_cat	60+		130

[[12]]

column	Var		n
:-----	:-----		---:
Edu	none		24
Edu	primary		153
Edu	secondary		699
Edu	higher_ed		197

[[13]]

column	Var		n
:-----	:-----		---:
Urban	rural		368
Urban	urban		705

[[14]]

column	Var		n
:-----	:-----		---:
Employment	Employed		561
Employment	house_wife		263
Employment	Retired		31
Employment	Student		86
Employment	Unemployed		132

[[15]]

column	Var	n
:-----	---:	---:
satis_demo_lb	1	63
satis_demo_lb	2	111
satis_demo_lb	3	588
satis_demo_lb	4	311

[[16]]

column	Var	n
:-----	---:	---:
governed_for	1	872
governed_for	2	201

We are left with n=1,073

We now move to exploratory factor analysis for each survey trust items.

Lapop EFA with one-three factors

```
#
# Exploratory Factor Analysis - Reusable Function
#

run_efa <- function(items_df, max_factors = 3, seed = 721) {

  # Coerce to numeric, drop incomplete cases
  items_df <- items_df |> drop_na() |> mutate(across(everything(), as.numeric))
  cat(sprintf("EFA: %d cases, %d items\n\n", nrow(items_df), ncol(items_df)))

  # Polychoric correlations - appropriate for ordinal items
  R <- polychoric(items_df)$rho

  # Parallel analysis - compare observed eigenvalues to simulated null
  set.seed(seed)
  pa <- fa.parallel(R, n.obs = nrow(items_df), fa = "fa", cor = "cor",
                    plot = TRUE, main = "Parallel Analysis")

  # Fit 1 through max_factors - oblimin rotation for correlated factors
  models <- map(1:max_factors, \(nf) {
    fa(R, nfactors = nf, n.obs = nrow(items_df),
        rotate = if (nf == 1) "none" else "oblimin",
        fm = "wls", cor = "cor")
  }) |> set_names(paste0("f", 1:max_factors))

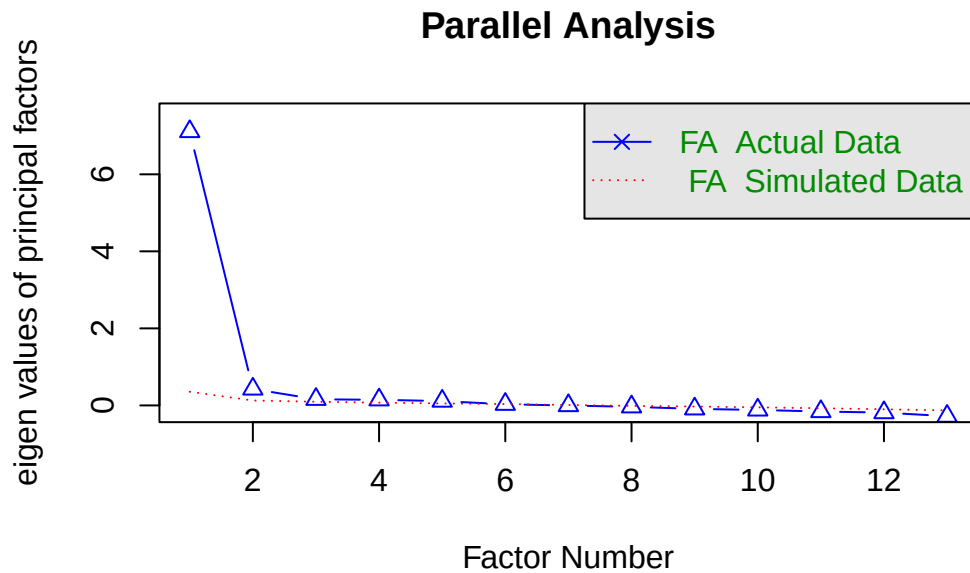
  # Comparison table - TLI, RMSEA, BIC for model selection
  comparison <- imap_dfr(models, \(mod, name) {
    tibble(model = name, factors = mod$factors,
           TLI = mod$TLI, RMSEA = mod$RMSEA[1],
           BIC = mod$BIC,
           prop_var = sum(mod$Vaccounted["Proportion Var", ]))
  })
  cat("\n"); print(comparison, width = Inf)

  # Print sorted loadings (cutoff = 0.3) for each solution
  walk(models, \(mod) {
    cat(sprintf("\n-- %d-factor loadings --\n", mod$factors))
    print(mod$loadings, cutoff = 0.3, sort = TRUE)
  })

  # Return key objects for downstream CFA specification
  invisible(list(polychoric = R, parallel = pa, models = models,
                comparison = comparison, n_suggested = pa$nfact))
}
```

```
lapop_trust <- run_efa(lapop |> select(justice_system:elections), max_factors = 3)
```

EFA: 1430 cases, 13 items



Parallel analysis suggests that the number of factors = 5 and the number of components = NA

Loading required namespace: GPArotation

Warning in fa.stats(r = r, f = f, phi = phi, n.obs = n.obs, np.obs = np.obs, :
The estimated weights for the factor scores are probably incorrect. Try a
different factor score estimation method.

A tibble: 3 x 6

	model	factors	TLI	RMSEA	BIC	prop_var
	<chr>	<int>	<dbl>	<dbl>	<dbl>	<dbl>
1	f1	1	0.885	0.113	786.	0.547
2	f2	2	0.908	0.101	447.	0.590
3	f3	3	0.913	0.0985	320.	0.644

-- 1-factor loadings --

Loadings:

	WLS1
justice_system	0.859
electoral_tribunal	0.720
armed_forces	0.604
legislature	0.778
public_ministry	0.814
police	0.726
auditor	0.829
political_parties	0.771
president	0.542
supreme_court	0.801
municipality	0.736
media	0.579
elections	0.774

```

                WLS1
SS loadings    7.110
Proportion Var 0.547

```

-- 2-factor loadings --

Loadings:

	WLS1	WLS2
justice_system	0.855	
electoral_tribunal	0.803	
armed_forces	0.534	
legislature	0.733	
public_ministry	0.855	
police	0.675	
auditor	0.861	
political_parties	0.729	
supreme_court	0.774	
municipality	0.721	
media	0.647	
elections	0.747	
president	0.431	0.472

	WLS1	WLS2
SS loadings	6.939	0.582
Proportion Var	0.534	0.045
Cumulative Var	0.534	0.578

-- 3-factor loadings --

Loadings:

	WLS1	WLS3	WLS2
justice_system	0.785		
electoral_tribunal	0.866		
public_ministry	0.862		
auditor	0.803		
political_parties	0.559		
supreme_court	0.653		
municipality	0.589		
media	0.701		
elections	0.609		
armed_forces		0.802	
legislature		0.621	
president			0.990
police	0.372	0.391	

	WLS1	WLS3	WLS2
SS loadings	4.929	1.246	1.123
Proportion Var	0.379	0.096	0.086
Cumulative Var	0.379	0.475	0.561

- We find that a one factor solution is feasible but has a poor fit indicated by TLI and RMSEA. It seems that trust in the president might be a problematic item.

We now conduct a CFA one and two factor model on the lapop trust items

```
#
# CFA - 1-Factor and 2-Factor Models (LAPOP Mexico Trust Items)
#

set.seed(721)

diagnose_cfa <- function(fit, label) {

  cat(sprintf("\n%s\n  %s\n%s\n", strrep("=", 60), label, strrep("=", 60)))

  fm <- fitmeasures(fit, c("chisq.scaled", "df.scaled", "pvalue.scaled",
                           "cfi.scaled", "tli.scaled",
                           "rmsea.scaled", "rmsea.ci.lower.scaled",
                           "rmsea.ci.upper.scaled", "srmr"))
  cat(sprintf("\nchi2 = %.1f (df = %.0f, p = %.4f)\n", fm[1], fm[2], fm[3]))
  cat(sprintf("CFI = %.3f | TLI = %.3f | RMSEA = %.3f [%.3f, %.3f] | SRMR = %.3f\n",
              fm[4], fm[5], fm[6], fm[7], fm[8], fm[9]))

  std <- standardizedSolution(fit) |>
    filter(op == "~") |>
    select(factor = lhs, item = rhs, loading = est.std, p = pvalue) |>
    filter(!is.na(loading)) |>
    arrange(factor, desc(abs(loading)))
  cat("\nLoadings:\n"); print(as.data.frame(std))

  fcor <- standardizedSolution(fit) |>
    filter(op == "~", lhs != rhs, lhs %in% std$factor, rhs %in% std$factor)
  if (nrow(fcor) > 0)
    cat(sprintf("\nFactor correlation: %.3f\n", fcor$est.std[1]))

  omega <- tryCatch(compRelSEM(fit), error = function(e) NULL)
  ave <- tryCatch(AVE(fit), error = function(e) NULL)
  if (!is.null(omega)) cat(sprintf("omega: %s\n",
    paste(names(omega), round(omega, 3), sep = " = ", collapse = ", ")))
  if (!is.null(ave)) cat(sprintf("AVE: %s\n",
    paste(names(ave), round(ave, 3), sep = " = ", collapse = ", ")))

  mi <- modificationIndices(fit, sort. = TRUE, op = "~", free.remove = FALSE) |>
    filter(mi > 10) |>
    slice_head(n = 5)
  if (nrow(mi) > 0) {
    cat("\nTop modification indices (> 10):\n")
    print(as.data.frame(mi |> select(lhs, rhs, mi)))
  }

  invisible(fit)
}
```

We find that the president trust item is problematic and test a 1 factor cfa without.

```
trust_items_lapop <- c("justice_system", "electoral_tribunal", "armed_forces",
  "legislature", "public_ministry", "police", "auditor",
```

```

      "political_parties", "supreme_court", "municipality",
      "media", "elections")

trust_lapop_df <- lapop |> select(all_of(trust_items_lapop))

# 1-factor, 12 items, freed residual covariances
mod_1f_trim <- '
  Trust =~ justice_system + electoral_tribunal + armed_forces +
           legislature + public_ministry + police + auditor +
           political_parties + supreme_court + municipality +
           media + elections
  armed_forces ~~ legislature
  public_ministry ~~ auditor
'

fit_1f_trim <- cfa(mod_1f_trim, data = trust_lapop_df,
                  ordered = setdiff(trust_items_lapop, "president"),
                  estimator = "WLSMV")

diagnose_cfa(fit_1f_trim, "1-FACTOR (12 items, 2 freed covariances)")

```

```

=====
1-FACTOR (12 items, 2 freed covariances)
=====

chi2 = 698.0 (df = 52, p = 0.0000)
CFI = 0.978 | TLI = 0.972 | RMSEA = 0.093 [0.087, 0.099] | SRMR = 0.033

```

```

Loadings:
  factor      item  loading p
1  Trust      justice_system 0.8697208 0
2  Trust      auditor 0.8217229 0
3  Trust      public_ministry 0.8071957 0
4  Trust      supreme_court 0.8060352 0
5  Trust      elections 0.7709621 0
6  Trust      political_parties 0.7684410 0
7  Trust      legislature 0.7627986 0
8  Trust      electoral_tribunal 0.7431646 0
9  Trust      municipality 0.7360246 0
10 Trust      police 0.7321006 0
11 Trust      media 0.5967398 0
12 Trust      armed_forces 0.5751952 0
omega: Trust = 0.931
AVE:   Trust = 0.568

```

```

Top modification indices (> 10):
      lhs      rhs      mi
1      police political_parties 33.79123
2      supreme_court      elections 25.89944
3      justice_system      supreme_court 24.59651
4      electoral_tribunal      media 24.39812
5      armed_forces      police 22.79241

```


12-item unidimensional Institutional Trust factor, with two freed residual covariances (armed_forces ~ legislature, public_ministry ~ auditor), president dropped. This is what the data support — the EFA said one dominant factor, the CFA confirms it once the misfit item is removed and substantively justified correlated errors are freed. This will be our production script.

We move to estimating the correlation between the latent factor and our outcome variables.

```
# Factor scores
fs <- lavPredict(fit_1f_trim, method = "regression") |> as_tibble()

lapop_fs <- lapop |>
  filter(if_all(all_of(trust_items_lapop), ~ !is.na(.x))) |>
  bind_cols(fs)

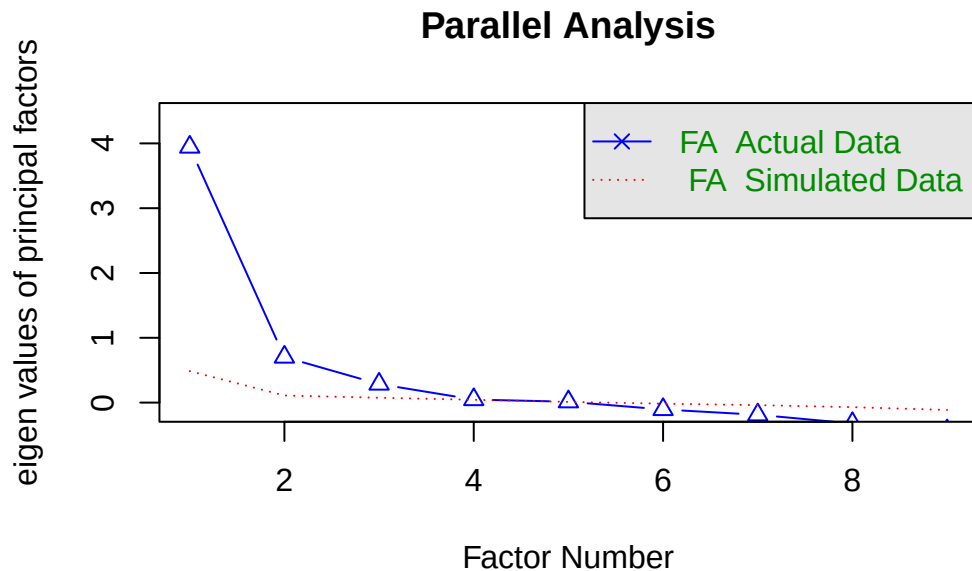
# Correlations
cor(lapop_fs$Trust,
    lapop_fs |> select(satis_demo_lapop, prez_rating) |> mutate(across(everything(), as.numeric)),
    use = "complete.obs")
```

```
      satis_demo_lapop prez_rating
[1,]      -0.3326396  -0.2617839
```

We now explore the factor structure of the LB data.

```
lb_trust <- run_efa(lb |> select(Armed_forces:President), max_factors = 3)
```

EFA: 1073 cases, 9 items



Parallel analysis suggests that the number of factors = 5 and the number of components = NA

A tibble: 3 x 6

	model	factors	TLI	RMSEA	BIC	prop_var
	<chr>	<int>	<dbl>	<dbl>	<dbl>	<dbl>
1	f1	1	0.636	0.215	1182.	0.439
2	f2	2	0.768	0.172	490.	0.552
3	f3	3	0.693	0.198	431.	0.640

-- 1-factor loadings --

Loadings:

	WLS1
Police	0.544
Congress	0.746
Natl_Govt	0.754
Judiciary	0.779
Parties	0.753
Electoral_Inst	0.764
President	0.664
Armed_forces	0.492
Church	

	WLS1
SS loadings	3.947
Proportion Var	0.439

-- 2-factor loadings --

Loadings:

	WLS1	WLS2
Natl_Govt	0.919	
President	0.893	
Armed_forces		0.693
Police		0.771
Church		0.464
Congress	0.473	0.385
Judiciary	0.495	0.408
Parties	0.499	0.357
Electoral_Inst	0.491	0.389

	WLS1	WLS2
SS loadings	2.609	1.897
Proportion Var	0.290	0.211
Cumulative Var	0.290	0.501

-- 3-factor loadings --

Loadings:

	WLS1	WLS2	WLS3
Congress	0.675		
Natl_Govt	0.850		
Judiciary	0.651		
Parties	0.708		
Electoral_Inst	0.661		
President	0.802		
Armed_forces		0.871	
Police		0.781	
Church			0.851

	WLS1	WLS2	WLS3
SS loadings	3.186	1.421	0.899
Proportion Var	0.354	0.158	0.100
Cumulative Var	0.354	0.512	0.612

The Latinobarómetro trust items are clearly not unidimensional. The 1-factor model is unacceptable (TLI = .636, RMSEA = .215), meaning these 9 items cannot be treated as measuring a single construct. The 3-factor solution provides the cleanest simple structure: Factor 1 is political trust (Natl_Govt .85, President .80, Parties .71, Congress .68, Electoral_Inst .66, Judiciary .65), Factor 2 is security institutions (Armed_forces .87, Police .78), and Factor 3 is Church alone (.85). Factor correlations are moderate and distinct (.45, .34, .20), confirming these are separable dimensions. The 2-factor solution is messy — Congress, Judiciary, Parties, and Electoral_Inst all cross-load heavily (complexity ~1.9), meaning the 2-factor structure forces ambiguous assignments. Church is the problem item: it loads .29 on the general factor, forms its own single-item factor in the 3-factor solution, and has near-zero correlations with President (.03) and Natl_Govt (.08). It is substantively distinct from institutional trust and should be dropped. That leaves a 2-factor CFA: Political Trust (6 items) and Security Trust (Armed_forces, Police), with Natl_Govt ~ President ($r = .81$ in the polychoric matrix) as a likely candidate for a freed residual covariance.

```
#
# CFA - Latinobarómetro Colombia (8 items, Church dropped)
#
```

```

set.seed(721)

trust_items_lb <- c("Armed_forces", "Police", "Congress", "Natl_Govt",
                   "Judiciary", "Parties", "Electoral_Inst", "President")

trust_lb_df <- lb |> select(all_of(trust_items_lb))

# 1-factor (baseline)
mod_lb_1f <- '
  Trust =~ Armed_forces + Police + Congress + Natl_Govt +
           Judiciary + Parties + Electoral_Inst + President
'

# 2-factor (EFA-informed)
mod_lb_2f <- '
  Political =~ Congress + Natl_Govt + Judiciary + Parties +
            Electoral_Inst + President
  Security  =~ Armed_forces + Police
'

# 2-factor with freed covariance
mod_lb_2f_free <- '
  Political =~ Congress + Natl_Govt + Judiciary + Parties +
            Electoral_Inst + President
  Security  =~ Armed_forces + Police
  Natl_Govt ~~ President
'

# Fit all three
fit_lb_1f <- cfa(mod_lb_1f, data = trust_lb_df,
                 ordered = trust_items_lb, estimator = "WLSMV")
fit_lb_2f <- cfa(mod_lb_2f, data = trust_lb_df,
                 ordered = trust_items_lb, estimator = "WLSMV")
fit_lb_2f_free <- cfa(mod_lb_2f_free, data = trust_lb_df,
                     ordered = trust_items_lb, estimator = "WLSMV")

# Diagnose
diagnose_cfa(fit_lb_1f, "LB 1-Factor (8 items)")

```

```

=====
LB 1-Factor (8 items)
=====

chi2 = 1360.1 (df = 20, p = 0.0000)
CFI = 0.833 | TLI = 0.766 | RMSEA = 0.250 [0.239, 0.261] | SRMR = 0.124

Loadings:
  factor      item    loading p
1  Trust      Natl_Govt 0.8476955 0
2  Trust      President 0.7826714 0
3  Trust      Parties 0.7418788 0
4  Trust      Judiciary 0.7346768 0

```

```

5 Trust Electoral_Inst 0.7268131 0
6 Trust      Congress 0.7066062 0
7 Trust      Police 0.6405387 0
8 Trust Armed_forces 0.6179146 0
omega: Trust = 0.95
AVE:   Trust = 0.53

```

Top modification indices (> 10):

	lhs	rhs	mi
1	Armed_forces	Police	616.87830
2	Natl_Govt	President	390.99560
3	Police	President	101.02013
4	Armed_forces	Natl_Govt	87.19340
5	Police	Natl_Govt	81.35119

```
diagnose_cfa(fit_lb_2f, "LB 2-Factor: Political + Security")
```

```

=====
LB 2-Factor: Political + Security
=====

```

```

chi2 = 600.3 (df = 19, p = 0.0000)
CFI = 0.927 | TLI = 0.893 | RMSEA = 0.169 [0.157, 0.181] | SRMR = 0.076

```

Loadings:

	factor	item	loading	p
1	Political	Natl_Govt	0.8617955	0
2	Political	President	0.8004135	0
3	Political	Parties	0.7593113	0
4	Political	Judiciary	0.7509727	0
5	Political	Electoral_Inst	0.7430499	0
6	Political	Congress	0.7228850	0
7	Security	Police	0.8749379	0
8	Security	Armed_forces	0.7869793	0

Factor correlation: 0.519

omega: Political = 0.901, Security = 0.764

AVE: Political = 0.6, Security = 0.692

Top modification indices (> 10):

	lhs	rhs	mi
1	Natl_Govt	President	291.23538
2	Natl_Govt	Parties	40.77779
3	Parties	President	37.69564
4	Congress	President	33.45876
5	Congress	Parties	32.00420

```
diagnose_cfa(fit_lb_2f_free, "LB 2-Factor + freed Natl_Govt ~~ President")
```

```

=====
LB 2-Factor + freed Natl_Govt ~~ President
=====

```

```
chi2 = 113.9 (df = 18, p = 0.0000)
CFI = 0.988 | TLI = 0.981 | RMSEA = 0.071 [0.058, 0.083] | SRMR = 0.033
```

Loadings:

	factor	item	loading	p
1	Political	Judiciary	0.7948272	0
2	Political	Parties	0.7896473	0
3	Political	Electoral_Inst	0.7798566	0
4	Political	Congress	0.7597465	0
5	Political	Natl_Govt	0.7064816	0
6	Political	President	0.6030639	0
7	Security	Police	0.8764833	0
8	Security	Armed_forces	0.7855917	0

Factor correlation: 0.550

omega: Political = 0.793, Security = 0.764

AVE: Political = 0.551, Security = 0.693

```
# LRT comparison
lavTestLRT(fit_lb_1f, fit_lb_2f)
```

Scaled Chi-Squared Difference Test (method = "satorra.2000")

```
lavaan->lavTestLRT():
```

lavaan NOTE: The "Chisq" column contains standard test statistics, not the robust test that should be reported per model. A robust difference test is a function of two standard (not robust) statistics.

	Df	AIC	BIC	Chisq	Chisq diff	RMSEA	Df diff	Pr(>Chisq)
fit_lb_2f	19			345.10				
fit_lb_1f	20			961.08	274.38	0.75706	1	< 2.2e-16 ***

Signif. codes: 0 '***' 0.001 '**' 0.01 '*' 0.05 '.' 0.1 ' ' 1

The 2-factor with freed Natl_Govt ~ President is the Colombia measurement model. CFI = .988, TLI = .981, RMSEA = .071, SRMR = .033 — all criteria pass. The factor correlation at .550 is moderate, confirming Political and Security are genuinely distinct dimensions (unlike the LAPOP 2-factor at .910). The LRT confirms the 2-factor is significantly better than 1-factor.

```
fs_lb <- lavPredict(fit_lb_2f_free, method = "regression") |> as_tibble()

lb_fs <- lb |>
  filter(if_all(all_of(trust_items_lb), ~ !is.na(.x))) |>
  bind_cols(fs_lb)

cor(lb_fs |> select(Political, Security),
    lb_fs |> select(satis_demo_lb, governed_for) |> mutate(across(everything(), as.numeric)),
    use = "complete.obs")
```

	satis_demo_lb	governed_for
Political	0.3701401	-0.28595316
Security	0.2124642	-0.06715334

Political Trust → **satis_demo_lb** (r = .37): Higher factor score (less trust) → higher satis_demo values (less satisfied). Equivalently, people who trust political institutions more are more satisfied with

democracy. Intuitive direction, moderate-strong relationship.

Political Trust → governed_for ($r = -.29$): Higher factor score (less trust) → lower governed_for (1 = powerful groups). People with less political trust think the country is governed by powerful groups. Intuitive direction, moderate relationship.

Security → satis_demo_lb ($r = .21$): Same direction as Political but weaker. Security institution trust matters less for democratic satisfaction.

Security → governed_for ($r = -.07$): Essentially zero. Whether you trust the armed forces and police has almost no bearing on whether you think the country is governed for everyone's benefit. This makes substantive sense — governance perceptions are about political power, not security institutions.

We drop the security factor and find cleaner results.

	LAPOP Mexico	Latinobarómetro Colombia
Items	12 (of 13, president dropped)	6 (of 9, Church/Armed_forces/Police dropped)
Factors	1 (Trust)	1 (Political)
Freed covariances	armed_forces ~~ legislature, public_ministry ~~ auditor	Natl_Govt ~~ President
CFI / TLI	.964 / .955	.992 / .985
RMSEA	.056	.077
omega	.922	.793
AVE	.521	.551
→ satis_demo	r = -.33	r = .37
→ prez_rating / governed_for	r = -.26	r = -.30

```
#
# Final CFA Models - Both Surveys
#

# LAPOP Mexico: 12-item unidimensional Trust
# President dropped (weak loading, single-item EFA factor, misfit source)
# Two freed residual covariances (substantively justified):
#   armed_forces ~~ legislature      (state power institutions)
#   public_ministry ~~ auditor      (oversight/accountability bodies)

lapop_cfa <- '
  Trust =~ justice_system + electoral_tribunal + armed_forces +
           legislature + public_ministry + police + auditor +
           political_parties + supreme_court + municipality +
           media + elections
  armed_forces ~~ legislature
  public_ministry ~~ auditor
'

# Latinobarómetro Colombia: 6-item unidimensional Political Trust
# Church dropped (h2 = .085, near-zero correlations with political items)
# Armed_forces and Police dropped (Security factor uncorrelated with outcomes)
# One freed residual covariance (substantively justified):
#   Natl_Govt ~~ President (polychoric r = .81, conceptual overlap)

lb_cfa <- '
  Political =~ Congress + Natl_Govt + Judiciary + Parties +
             Electoral_Inst + President
  Natl_Govt ~~ President
'
```

To save data into a .rds we will combine both surveys into a list with two elements.

```
survey_list <- list(
  # drop president variable
  lapop |> select(-president),
```



```
# drop armed forces, police, and church
lb |> select(-Armed_forces:-Church)) |>
  set_names(c("lapop", "lb"))

write_rds(survey_list,
  file = str_c(
    results_dir, "/survey_data.rds")
)
```